presence in the world, on the one hand, and its contribution to and representation in global economic governance, on the other. By the early 2000s, and against the backdrop of China's huge trade surplus against the United States and American accusations of Chinese "currency manipulation," the U.S. administration called for China to step up its contribution to global governance as a "responsible stakeholder."[56] From its own point of view, however, China has always behaved as a "responsible great power,"[57] and to be expected to contribute to global public goods with no increase in its influence in the global governance system was unacceptable.[58]

In any case, since the global financial crisis, the Western powers have lost the grounds for accusing China of free-riding. China's economy has contributed mightily to global economic recovery, as well as to economic growth in the developing world.[59] China is now one of the largest contributors of foreign aid to Africa, and its outward direct investment around the world has created an economic boom from Australia to Ecuador.[60]

In addition, it has begun to contribute directly to multilateral institutions, both regional and global.[61] In the region, China (including Hong Kong) and Japan are the largest contributors to the CMI. Globally, it has been using its large sovereign wealth funds (SWFs), such as the China Investment Corporation and the SAFE Investment Company, to forge new political-financial ties in many corners of the world.

Moreover, China is now stepping up its contribution to the IMF. As the Eurozone's sovereign debt crisis deepened in 2011, at the top of the agenda at the Cannes G20 summit was the question of how to enhance the financial resources available to the IMF so it could implement multiple rescue efforts for Europe and beyond. For that purpose, China committed $43 billion, along with other BRICS members ($10 billion each from Brazil, Russia, and India and $2 billion from South Africa), boosting the IMF's resources by a total of $75 billion.

With $3 trillion in its foreign exchange reserves and high domestic savings,[62] China's financial power now allows the Chinese government to fund domestic, regional, and global funding projects simultaneously.[63] That means that taking the main financier role for the newly installed AIIB does not constrain China from also funding both the BRICS's NDB and its